"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 18

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

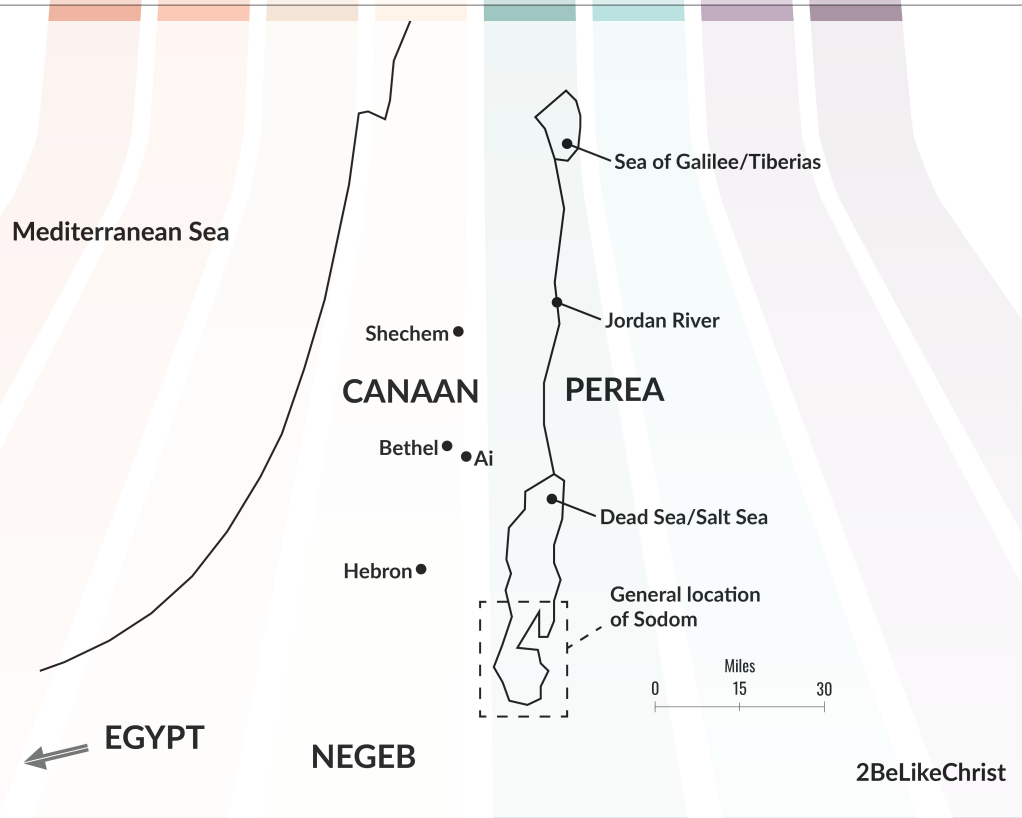
- Abram was born in approximately 1996 B.C. and died in 1821 B.C. at 175 years old (Gen 25:7).
- The events recorded in Genesis 18 happened when Abram was 99 years old (approximately 1897 B.C.).

Characters:

- **Abram** – A man from Ur of the Chaldeans who moved to Canaan at God's instruction. God promised to make his descendants a great nation and to give them the land of Canaan.
- **Sarah** – Abram's wife. She was barren and couldn't conceive children.
- **The Lord** – God visited Abraham and Sarah in the form of a man.
- **Angels** – 2 Angels accompanied the LORD to Abraham's tent.

Where:

- Abraham was living near the oaks of Mamre when the Lord visited him and Sarah. According to Genesis 13:18, the oaks of Mamre were in Hebron.
- Towards the end of the chapter, the focus shifts towards the city of Sodom, a wicked city where Abraham's nephew Lot lived.



Outline:

- ABRAHAM HOSTS 3 HEAVENLY GUESTS (18:1-15):
    + The Lord and two men, who we will later discover were angels, visited Abraham at his tent near the oaks of Mamre.
    + Abraham invited his guests to rest under a tree to refresh themselves from their journey.
    + Sarah prepared flour cakes and Abraham made arrangements for a calf to be slaughtered and cooked.
    + While the Lord and His angels ate the food, the Lord repeated His promise that Abraham and Sarah would have a son (see Genesis 17).
    + Sarah, who was listening at the door of the tent, laughed when she heard it because she was "advanced in years" and the "way of women had ceased" with her.
    + The Lord asked Abraham why Sarah had laughed, saying, "Is anything too hard for the LORD?"
    + Sarah denied that she had laughed because she was afraid.
    + The Lord restated the promise and told them they would have a son when He returned to them the next year.
- ABRAHAM NEGOTIATES WITH THE LORD TO SAVE SODOM (18:16-33):
    + Having enjoyed Abraham's hospitality, the Lord and His two angels departed towards the city of Sodom.
    + The Lord told Abraham of His intention to punish Sodom for its wickedness and immortality.
    + This news concerned Abraham because he didn't want the small number of righteous people in Sodom to die on account of their wicked neighbors.
    + He asked the Lord to spare Sodom if He found 50 righteous people, and the Lord agreed.
    + He then asked the Lord to spare the city if He found 45 righteous people, and the Lord agreed.
    + He then asked the Lord to spare the city if He found 40 righteous people, and the Lord agreed.
    + Abraham continued lowering the number until God agreed to spare Sodom if 10 righteous people could be found in the city.
    + After their conversation, the Lord departed and Abraham returned to his tent.

Application:

- Aren't you thankful we have a God who is patient enough to be laughed at?
- Most men in positions of authority don't tolerate their inferiors laughing at them.
- They are quick to reprimand, or demote, or imprison, or sometimes kill people who laugh at them.
- But God, the most powerful being in existence, was still willing to bless Sarah after she laughed at His words.
- Praise God for being exceedingly patient while being exceedingly powerful.